Morning Briefing

Wednesday, 8 July 2026 | Generated ~08:00 BST | London timezone

Data covers: US session Tue 7 Jul + European close Tue 7 Jul + Asian overnight Tue night into Wed morning

Iran struck a third tanker in the Strait of Hormuz; the US retaliated with strikes on ~80 targets and revoked Iran's oil-sanctions waiver, reigniting the fragile April ceasefire and pushing Brent up ~3%. A second wave of AI/chip-sector selling (Samsung/DeepSeek-driven) hit tech overnight, and Asian markets were highly volatile. FOMC minutes are due at 19:00 London time — the first release under new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh. NATO's Ankara Summit concludes today (day 2 of 2).

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Iran strikes a third tanker in the Strait of Hormuz; US retaliates with strikes on ~80 targets and revokes Iran's oil-sanctions waiver

CNN / CNBC / Al Jazeera — 7-8 Jul 2026

Directly threatens the fragile April ceasefire (Islamabad Memorandum, signed 17 Jun). The dominant risk event for today's open — driving oil, gold and defensive-sector flows.

Global chip-stock selloff deepens: Samsung's blowout Q2 guidance fails to reassure on AI-capex sustainability; DeepSeek reportedly developing its own AI chip

CNBC / 24/7 Wall St. / Investing.com — 7 Jul 2026

Nasdaq -1.16%; European semis followed hard (ASML -7.3%, BESI -6.3%, ASM International -7.0%, Infineon/STMicro >4% lower, Soitec ~-10%). Sets a weak tech tone for the European open given the Stoxx 600's semis exposure.

NATO Ankara Summit concludes today (day 2 of 2); defense stocks rally on "delivery" push for 2.5%-of-GDP spending targets

CNBC / Al Jazeera / NATO.int — 7-8 Jul 2026

Leonardo, Saab, Hensoldt, Thales, Dassault Aviation, Safran, BAE Systems all up 2-5%. Rheinmetall's gain was capped by Germany cancelling its F126 frigate program in favour of ThyssenKrupp Marine Systems.

EasyJet board agrees in principle to a £5.5bn (£6.90/share) Castlelake takeover

Bloomberg / CNBC / Irish Times — 6-7 Jul 2026

Shares jumped ~10% on the news after four prior rejected bids; formal offer due by 3 Aug under UK Takeover Code rules or the offer lapses. Aviation-sector M&A catalyst.

FOMC June meeting minutes due today at 19:00 London time — first release under new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh

CNBC / Federal Reserve — 8 Jul 2026

Preview commentary flags a "hawkish" June dot plot; Warsh said at the ECB's Sintra forum (1 Jul) that rate cuts remain "off the table for now." Key read on the post-Powell reaction function amid Iran-driven inflation risk — USD/rates volatility likely into the release.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES — PRE-OPEN

Source: Reuters/TradingView premarket wire, Investing.com, MarketScreener. Data collected ~07:00-07:30 BST Wed 8 Jul.

Index	Futures Level	Expected Move	Notes
Euro Stoxx 50	~6,326 (range 6,283-6,338)	**-0.1% to -0.3%**	Soft/cautious open flagged by Reuters after the overnight chip rout; Iran/Hormuz escalation adding a second headwind
DAX	n/a	**-0.1% to -0.3%**	Grouped with Euro Stoxx 50 in the same "cautious start" Reuters wire
CAC 40	n/a	Cautious / soft	No CAC-specific futures figure sourced; general "Europe soft" framing applies
FTSE 100	n/a	**-0.1% to -0.3%**	Energy-heavy index may outperform peers given the Brent spike
S&P 500 (E-Mini)	7,549.25	**-2.00 pts (-0.03%)**	Essentially flat premarket after Tuesday's chip-led losses
Nasdaq (E-Mini)	29,397.25	**+5.75 pts (+0.02%)**	Flat/stabilising after the two-session chip selloff
Dow (E-Mini)	53,150.00	**-47.00 pts (-0.09%)**	Little changed

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — TUESDAY 7 JULY 2026

Source: Trading Economics, Yahoo Finance, BBN Times, CNBC-sourced aggregation. Levels marked "~" are approximate.

Index	Level	Change	% Change	Session Note
Euro Stoxx 50	6,398	▼/flat	~flat (-0.2% to +0.04% depending on source)	Tech drag from ASML (-1.5%) and Infineon (-3.2%); luxury (LVMH, Hermès) also softer
DAX	~25,460-470	▼	**-1.37%**	Heavily weighed down by chip-exposed Infineon
CAC 40	8,431.66	▼	**-0.51%**	Early luxury rally (JPMorgan Q2 commentary) reversed as the chip selloff and oil-price jump spread
FTSE 100	~10,663	▲	**+0.13%**	Outlier gainer; Shell/energy strength offset the global chip rout, London's lower tech weighting insulated it
Stoxx 600	~650.50 (unconfirmed)	▼	**-0.65%**	Broader gauge dragged by the semis rout

European bourses were mixed Tuesday. The FTSE 100 was the lone gainer on energy strength; DAX was the laggard on its heavy chip-sector exposure via Infineon.

5. US MARKETS — TUESDAY 7 JULY 2026 SESSION

Source: TheStreet, CNBC, Yahoo Finance. Data as of Tuesday's close.

Index	Close	Change (pts)	% Change	Notes
S&P 500	7,503.85	▼	-0.45%	Broad but orderly pullback
Nasdaq Composite	25,818.69	▼	-1.16%	Tech-led losses, worst of the three
Dow Jones	52,925.15	-130.76	-0.25%	Held up better than the tech-heavy gauges; had set a record close the prior session

Session tone: Risk-off in AI/semiconductor names for a second-plus consecutive session, partly offset by broader index resilience.

Leading sector — Energy: Oil spiked after Iran struck a Qatari LNG tanker near the Strait of Hormuz and the US revoked Iran's oil-sale waiver. Brent settled ~+3% at $74.16/bbl (after-hours spike to $76.04); WTI rose ~+2.8% to $70.44 (after-hours ~$72.25).

Lagging sector — Semiconductors/Tech: Triggered by Samsung's quarterly results (a ~19x YoY operating-profit jump seen as an "earnings paradox" that failed to reassure on AI-capex sustainability) plus reports China's DeepSeek is developing its own AI chip. Micron closed -4.7%; KLA, Marvell, Broadcom and AMD all declined; the VanEck Semiconductor ETF (SMH) fell >3%.

Key takeaway: A second wave of AI/chip-sector de-rating combined with a Middle East geopolitical shock drove a broad but orderly pullback — Dow/S&P held up better than Nasdaq given lower tech weighting and the energy-sector offset.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION (WED 8 JUL)

Source: Korea JoongAng Daily, Korea Herald, Invezz, BigGo Finance, TradingKey. This was an extremely volatile, fast-moving session (a Kospi circuit breaker carried through from Tuesday); final Wednesday closes for several indices could not be confirmed by collection time — flagged n/a where unconfirmed.

Index	Level (last confirmed)	Change	% Change	Session Note
Nikkei 225	68,256.96 (Tue close)	▼	-2.12% (Tue)	Tokyo Electron -3.94%, Kioxia -11.26% on chip contagion; Wed open showed renewed softness ~-1.3%, final close n/a
Hang Seng	23,496.98 (Tue close)	▼	-0.5% (Tue)	Wed close n/a — no reliably-dated same-day print sourced
Shanghai Composite	3,990.24 (Tue close)	▼	-1.3% (Tue)	Wed close n/a
Kospi	7,656.31 (Tue close, circuit-breaker triggered)	-4.91% (Tue)	Wed: -3.96% intraday low (7,352.89) then +1.65% rebound (7,782.44) by ~10:00 KST	Extremely volatile "second wave" session; Samsung and SK Hynix rebounded sharply on dip-buying. Final Wed close n/a

Tone: Contagion from the Wall Street/Samsung-led semiconductor selloff extended into a second Asian session, with Korea's chip giants (Samsung, SK Hynix) at the epicentre — Korea Exchange triggered its 6th circuit breaker of 2026 on Tuesday's Kospi plunge. Wednesday brought a partial stabilisation/rebound in Korean chip names as dip-buyers stepped in (SK Hynix +up to 5.8% intraday), while Japan saw continued weakness led by chip-equipment names. Iran/Strait-of-Hormuz oil strength added a secondary macro headwind across the region. Confirm today's final closing levels independently before trading — a clean same-session print was not available at collection time.

7. COMMODITIES

Source: CNBC, Investing.com, TradingEconomics, Barchart. Data collected ~07:30-08:00 BST Wed 8 Jul.

Commodity	Price	Change	% Change	Context
Brent Crude	~$76.18/bbl (Sep contract)	▲	+2.75%	Jumped after fresh US strikes on Iran; Joint Maritime Information Center raised its Strait of Hormuz threat assessment to "severe"
WTI Crude	~$72.46/bbl (Aug contract)	▲	+2.87%	Same Iran/Hormuz driver as Brent
Gold	~$4,125-4,150/oz	Choppy, two-sided	~flat	Squeezed between safe-haven demand (Iran escalation) and pressure from a firmer dollar/rising yields ahead of FOMC minutes
Natural Gas (TTF, Europe benchmark)	~€44.4/MWh (Mon close, stale)	Reported +up to 6% overnight	n/a exact print	Move tied to Qatari LNG's Strait of Hormuz dependency; confirm live print before use
Copper	~$6.17-6.21/lb	▼	-0.4%	Modest pullback, no single dominant driver identified

Notable: Oil is the dominant commodity story this morning, up nearly 3% on the Iran/Hormuz escalation and reversing the recent slide toward pre-war levels. European gas is also spiking on Qatari LNG supply-risk fears. Gold's muted reaction (choppy rather than a clean safe-haven spike) reflects the pull from a firmer dollar and rising yields ahead of tonight's FOMC minutes.

8. RATES & FX

Source: CNBC, Trading Economics, FXStreet, Bundesbank. Data as of ~07:30-08:00 BST Wed 8 Jul. German Bund yield shows a source discrepancy — flagged below.

Instrument	Level	Change	Notes
US 10Y Treasury Yield	4.50%	**▲, highest in 2 weeks**	Rising on Iran-driven inflation risk; Sept Fed hike odds priced up to ~58-63% from ~56-57%
German 10Y Bund Yield	~2.92-3.01% (range, unconfirmed)	n/a precise	Two sources diverge (2.92% steady vs 3.01% +~6bp); confirm against Bundesbank live data before use
EUR/USD	1.1407	**▼ from ~1.1412**	Defending the 1.1400 handle; safe-haven dollar demand from the Iran escalation capping gains
GBP/USD	~1.3355-1.3367	**▼ from ~1.3388**	Losing traction in Asian trading Wednesday
DXY (Dollar Index)	~100.90-101.00	**▲, near weekly highs**	Firm on safe-haven flows tied to the Hormuz escalation and rising Fed hike bets

The dollar is firm across the board on safe-haven demand from the Iran/Hormuz escalation, pressuring both EUR/USD and GBP/USD. US 10Y yields have pushed to a two-week high on the combination of oil-driven inflation risk and rising Fed hike odds. FOMC minutes (16-17 June meeting, first under Chair Warsh) are due at 19:00 London time today.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

Source: EU Commission press corner, PR Newswire, EQS News, Investing.com, ieu-monitoring.com. GlobalCapital/IFR primary-source deal terms were paywalled/blocked; figures below are drawn from issuer press releases and secondary coverage.

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES (TUE 7 JUL)

SSA — European Commission (EU-Bonds): Dual-tranche syndication, the EU's 7th of 2026. New 5Y €6bn, due 13 Oct 2031, coupon 2.875%, re-offer yield 2.947% — priced +10bp tighter than the comparable 2030 EU-Bond (~+11.9bp vs mid-swaps, +26bp vs Bund). Tap of 20Y €5bn, due 12 Oct 2046, coupon 4.000%, re-offer yield 4.018% — priced +6bp tighter (~+76.7bp vs mid-swaps, +55.5bp vs Bund). Total €11bn; combined book over €83bn — 13.8x oversubscribed.

Corporate IG (reverse Yankee) — Realty Income Corp: €600m senior unsecured notes, 3.625% coupon, due 30 Jul 2032, priced at 99.518% (yield 3.716%). Bookrunners: Barclays, BNP Paribas, RBC, Santander, Wells Fargo. IPT-to-pricing tightening not disclosed.

Corporate IG (real estate) — Aroundtown SA: €850m 5Y senior unsecured, 3.625% coupon — the company's first EUR senior issuance of 2026, book described as oversubscribed (exact size/IPT tightening not disclosed). Simultaneous tender offer on three legacy notes (0.375% '27, 5.375% '29, 4.800% '29), expiring 15 Jul.

EUR HY / Financials: No verifiable EUR corporate HY or FIG (senior/T2/AT1/covered) prints for 7 Jul specifically were sourced — flag as n/a, confirm against a terminal (IFR/GlobalCapital PMM, Bondradar).

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY & THIS WEEK

SSA: EU Commission's H2 2026 funding plan targets €80bn of EU-Bond issuance July-December (four syndication windows plus six auctions), part of a €180bn full-year target — implies further EU syndications later in Q3.

Corporate IG: Aroundtown's tender offer runs through 15 Jul — ongoing liability management, not new pipeline. The "reverse Yankee" wave (US corporates/financials funding in EUR) remains on pace to set a record past 2007, with more US issuers likely to tap euros given the ~170bp IG yield advantage (EUR IG ~3.1% vs USD IG ~4.8%).

No specific named roadshows or "mandated, expected to price" corporate/FIG deals for 8-10 Jul could be sourced from open web search — a terminal-based deal calendar would normally carry several live mandates on any given Wednesday that simply aren't indexed by open search.

KEY SPREADS

Index	Level	Move	Direction
iTraxx Main (5Y)	n/a	n/a	No reliable current-day source via open web search
iTraxx Crossover (5Y)	~315-320bp (stale, mid-May)	n/a today	Last sourced level tightened from ~410bp in Oct 2025; today's print unconfirmed
CDX IG (5Y)	n/a	n/a	No reliable source
Euro IG Corp Avg OAS	n/a	n/a	General commentary describes euro and US IG cash spreads sitting near multi-decade tights

COMMENTARY

The window is open and busy. The EU's 7th syndication of 2026 drew a €83bn book on an €11bn deal (13.8x covered) — a very strong SSA demand signal — while Realty Income and Aroundtown both placed EUR benchmarks in the same window, Aroundtown's oversubscribed. The reverse-Yankee wave continues to be the dominant structural theme feeding EUR IG corporate supply, as US issuers arbitrage the EUR-USD yield gap.

IG spreads sitting near multi-decade tights are encouraging issuers to move fast with tight new-issue premia rather than wait. Financials and industrials look the likeliest near-term movers; energy and transport issuers may be more selective given the fresh oil-price volatility from the Iran/Hormuz escalation. Key CDS index levels (iTraxx Main/Crossover, CDX IG) could not be sourced live today — confirm via terminal before referencing spread moves.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR

Source: Investing.com Economic Calendar, Trading Economics. Times approximate; no confirmed high-importance Eurozone/UK print was located specifically for 8 Jul — recommend a live calendar check before open.

Time (BST)	Indicator	Consensus	Import.	Notes
n/a	**Eurozone / UK first-tier data**	n/a	MED	No confirmed high-importance print located for today; the recent German IP and Eurozone retail sales prints were released 6-7 Jul, ahead of today
~12:00	**US MBA Mortgage Applications (weekly)**	n/a (prior ~0.0%)	LOW	Routine weekly release
~15:00	**US Wholesale Trade Sales (May)**	n/a (prior +2.0%)	MED	Secondary US activity read
~15:30	**US EIA Crude Oil Inventories**	n/a (prior -3.775M bbl)	MED	Elevated relevance today given the Hormuz supply shock
19:00	**US FOMC Minutes (16-17 June meeting)**	—	HIGH	First minutes under Chair Warsh; market will parse tone given the Iran-driven inflation risk
~19:00	**US Consumer Credit (May)**	Forecast $16.90bn (prior $20.73bn)	LOW	Secondary release, same slot as FOMC minutes
Unconfirmed	**China CPI/PPI (June)**	n/a	HIGH	Exact release date for today vs 9-10 Jul could not be confirmed — check live before trading around it

Context: a light scheduled-data day. The dominant swing factors are the Iran/Hormuz situation and tonight's FOMC minutes, not the calendar itself.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

Source: Money Morning, Alphastreet, IG UK, TipRanks. Large-cap earnings coverage for 8 Jul specifically was thin/conflicting across sources — treat today's slate as light.

Company / Event	Type	Date	Notes
NATO Ankara Summit	Political/corporate event	8 Jul (day 2 of 2)	Concludes today; defense-contract announcements a live catalyst
Large-cap earnings (Europe/US)	Earnings	8 Jul	No major large-cap print confirmed for today — flag as light/n/a, spot-check a live terminal
Delta Air Lines	Q2 2026 earnings	10 Jul	Before the bell; consensus EPS ~$1.43-1.48, revenue ~$17.5bn — informal season-opener
B&M European Value Retail	AGM	21 Jul	St Helier, Jersey; 2026 annual report published
JPMorgan / Bank of America / Citigroup / Wells Fargo	Q2 2026 earnings	14 Jul	Opens the US bank earnings season

12. STOCKS TO WATCH — WEDNESDAY 8 JULY

Source: Bloomberg, CNBC, Investing.com, Yahoo Finance UK, Global Banking & Finance.

EasyJet (EZJ.L) **Upside — M&A**
Board agreed in principle to Castlelake's £5.5bn (£6.90/share) takeover; formal offer due by 3 Aug. Aviation-sector M&A catalyst.

Rheinmetall (RHM.DE) **Mixed — volatile**
Germany cancelled the F126 frigate program (Rheinmetall was expected lead contractor), opting for ThyssenKrupp instead; partially offset by NATO summit optimism and ATACMS co-production progress.

Leonardo / Saab / Hensoldt / Thales / Dassault Aviation / Safran / BAE Systems (Aerospace & Defense) **Upside**
NATO Ankara Summit "delivery" push on 2.5%-of-GDP spending targets; Iran/Hormuz escalation adds a geopolitical-risk premium tailwind.

Maersk / Hapag-Lloyd (Shipping) **Downside**
Both fell on plans to partially resume Suez Canal transit; the fresh Hormuz tanker attacks now add complication/volatility risk to the Red Sea-normalisation thesis.

Shell / BP / TotalEnergies (Energy) **Upside**
Geared to the overnight Brent surge (+~3%); Shell raised Q2 integrated-gas guidance while its Qatar Pearl GTL outage (Mideast-conflict related) is now expected to last ~1 year.

ASML / Infineon / STMicroelectronics / ASM International / BE Semiconductor / Soitec (Tech/Semis) **Downside**
Continuing sector-wide selloff triggered by Samsung's "priced in" Q2 results and rotation out of AI-capex-exposed names.

Ryanair (RYAAY) **Upside — momentum**
Citi raised its price target to €32.20 from €30; June traffic hit a monthly record, +7% y/y. Goldman moved to Hold while Bernstein stayed Buy — mixed broker view but strong operating momentum.

Novo Nordisk (NOVO-B.CO) **Upside — modest**
CEO pushing for imminent China approval of oral Wegovy after US/UK/UAE clearances; EMA review of the oral formulation ongoing.

Rio Tinto / Glencore (RIO.L / GLEN.L) **Watch — event risk**
~$260bn merger talks remain unresolved; no fresh confirmed catalyst today, but headline risk remains high given the saga's on-again, off-again history.

IAG / Wizz Air (Aviation) **Downside — cost pressure**
Exposed to the overnight jet-fuel/oil price spike from the Iran strikes, a cost headwind into earnings (Wizz Air reports 6 Aug); partially offset by the aviation M&A halo from the EasyJet deal.

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

Fed: First FOMC minutes under new Chair Kevin Warsh (16-17 June meeting) due today at 19:00 London time; preview commentary describes a "hawkish" June dot plot. Warsh said at the ECB's Sintra forum (1 Jul) that rate cuts remain "off the table for now."

ECB: Raised rates 25bp in June; Eurozone HICP inflation ran at 3.2% y/y in May (core 2.5%), with staff projecting headline inflation averaging 3.0% in 2026, largely on Middle-East-driven energy costs. Next decision 22-23 Jul.

BoE: Governor Bailey said at Sintra (1 Jul) that UK rate cuts remain "off the table for now"; he speaks again at the Mansion House dinner on 14 Jul.

Eurozone data: German industrial production surprised to the upside in May (+0.9% m/m vs +0.1% consensus) on a 3.6% jump in auto output; Eurozone retail sales rose 1.6% y/y in May, suggesting resilient consumption despite the energy-price shock.

CORPORATE

Chip sector: Global selloff extends into a second/third session — Samsung's record Q2 guidance failed to reassure investors on AI-capex sustainability, compounded by reports China's DeepSeek is developing its own AI chip. Hit memory/semicap names worldwide including European suppliers.

M&A: Global H1 2026 M&A hit a record $2.8tn (+48% y/y); European announced deal value up 82% y/y, led by UK inbound activity, including Engie's acquisition of UK Power Networks from Hong Kong's CK Group.

Sector rotation: Banks and defense stocks were the relative outperformers in Europe on 7 Jul (Deutsche Bank, ING, Intesa Sanpaolo each +1%+; Rheinmetall +3.5% pre-F126 news) — a rotation likely to extend given the fresh Hormuz escalation.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

Strait of Hormuz: Tanker attacks (7 Jul) and US retaliatory strikes threaten to unravel the April ceasefire/Islamabad Memorandum (60-day negotiation window signed 17 Jun); Iran's lead negotiator has accused the US of "major MOU violations." Top overnight risk event feeding into oil, gold and risk sentiment.

US trade policy: USTR Section 301 forced-labor tariff hearings (60 economies facing 10-12.5% duties, EU included) concluded 7 Jul; the broader 10% Section 122 global tariff surcharge is due to expire 24 Jul absent Congressional extension; the EU-US tariff deal took effect 1 Jul after the EU met the 4 Jul compliance deadline.

NATO: Ankara Summit (32 leaders, including Zelenskyy) concludes today, focused on defense-spending "delivery" and continued pressure on European burden-sharing.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5 (WEDNESDAY 8 JULY)

1. US Strikes on Iran / Hormuz Tanker Attacks

Brent up ~3% above $76/bbl overnight; the US revoked Iran's oil-sanctions waiver, directly threatening the June ceasefire. The single biggest swing factor for European energy, shipping and risk sentiment at today's open.

2. NATO Ankara Summit, Day 2

Concludes today; watch for defense-contract announcements and how the alliance formalises 2.5%-of-GDP spending "delivery."

3. European Semiconductor Selloff Continuation

Samsung's "good but priced in" results triggered a two-day sector rout (Soitec, BESI, Infineon, STMicro, ASMI); watch whether it extends or stabilises at the open.

4. EasyJet/Castlelake M&A Follow-Through

Continued market digestion of the £5.5bn deal and any read-across to other aviation/travel consolidation targets.

5. European Natural Gas Price Spike

Up to +6% overnight, tied to Qatari LNG's Strait of Hormuz dependency — a direct pass-through risk to European energy costs and utilities/industrials.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5 (6-12 JULY)

1. NATO Ankara Summit Outcomes

Defense-spending commitments and contract-pipeline announcements; markets will parse whether pledges translate into near-term order flow for Rheinmetall, Leonardo, Saab, Thales, BAE, Safran, Dassault.

2. Iran/Strait of Hormuz Crisis Trajectory

Whether the ceasefire survives this week's exchange of strikes; further escalation is the key tail risk for oil, gas and shipping insurance costs.

3. EasyJet Deal Process

Castlelake due diligence and documentation ahead of the 3 Aug formal-offer deadline under UK Takeover Code rules.

4. US Trade-Policy Deadlines

Section 301 determinations pending; the Section 122 blanket 10% global tariff surcharge expires 24 Jul; fallout from the US declining to extend USMCA by its 1 Jul deadline.

5. Positioning Ahead of US Bank Earnings

JPMorgan, Bank of America, Citigroup and Wells Fargo report 14-15 Jul, setting the tone for the global Q2 earnings season.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5 (JULY 2026)

1. US CPI (June Reading) — 14 Jul

Key input to Fed rate-path expectations, especially given June's soft 57,000 nonfarm payrolls print and the Iran-driven energy-price risk to the inflation outlook.

2. FOMC Meeting — 28-29 July

Markets will weigh labour-market softening against oil/gas-driven inflation risk from the Hormuz crisis.

3. ECB Governing Council — 23 July

A non-projection meeting assessing whether prior policy action is sufficient given Middle East-driven energy dynamics.

4. Bank of England MPC Decision — 30 July

Alongside a new Monetary Policy Report; Bank Rate has been held at 3.75% through the March, April and June meetings.

5. Section 122 Tariff Expiration (24 Jul) & Earnings Season Ramp

Together the month's key trade-policy and corporate-fundamentals swing factors, with European banks, industrials, luxury and energy majors reporting through July-August.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY — WEDNESDAY 8 JUL

- Iran/Hormuz escalation dominant: Brent >$76, European gas +up to 6%; oil-sensitive majors and defense names likely to outperform, airlines/shippers pressured
- Watch whether the European semiconductor rout extends or finds a floor
- Gold notably has NOT behaved as a classic safe haven — trading off real-yield expectations rather than geopolitical risk premium
- Single-stock catalysts: EasyJet/Castlelake follow-through, any fresh Rio Tinto/Glencore headlines, NATO-summit-linked defense contract news
- FOMC minutes at 19:00 London — first under Chair Warsh, key rates/USD catalyst into the US close

1 WEEK — 6-12 JUL

- Resolution path (or further breakdown) of the Iran ceasefire — a full collapse would be a major tail risk for European energy and shipping costs
- NATO summit contract announcements converting into confirmed order backlogs for European defense primes
- EasyJet deal documentation progress ahead of the 3 Aug bid deadline
- Trade-policy overhang: Section 301 determinations pending, Section 122 expiration (24 Jul) approaching
- Positioning into the 14-15 Jul US bank earnings kickoff

1 MONTH — JULY 2026

- Rate-decision bracket: ECB (23 Jul), BoE (30 Jul) and FOMC (28-29 Jul) all fall in the second half of the month, with US CPI (14 Jul) a key swing input
- Full Q2/H1 earnings season ramp-up across European banks, industrials, luxury and energy majors
- Section 122's blanket 10% tariff surcharge expires 24 Jul — a potential inflection point for global trade costs
- Structural theme: European rearmament/defense-spending delivery continuing to reshape capital allocation
- Persistent tail risk: any further breakdown of the fragile Iran ceasefire remains the key wildcard for energy prices and the eurozone inflation trajectory into the ECB's July decision

Sources used in this report:

- CNBC Markets — cnbc.com (Iran/oil strikes, chip selloff, gold, premarket movers)
- CNN / Al Jazeera — Iran/Strait of Hormuz strikes, NATO Ankara Summit
- Reuters / TradingView — European premarket futures wire
- Bloomberg — EasyJet/Castlelake deal, gold/rates commentary
- TheStreet / Yahoo Finance UK — US and European index closes, sector detail
- Korea JoongAng Daily / Korea Herald / Invezz / BigGo Finance / TradingKey — Asian index moves, Kospi circuit breaker
- Trading Economics / Investing.com / Barchart — commodities, Bund/Treasury yields, DXY, FX
- FXStreet — EUR/USD, GBP/USD, DXY commentary
- European Commission press corner / ieu-monitoring.com — EU-Bond syndication
- PR Newswire / EQS News / StockTitan — Realty Income, Aroundtown bond pricing
- PineBridge / ETF Trends — IG credit spread commentary
- USTR / Federal Reserve / ECB / Bank of England — policy calendar and statements
- Money Morning / Alphastreet / IG UK / TipRanks — earnings and corporate calendar

Data collected automatically ~07:00-08:00 BST, Wednesday 8 July 2026. Verify all figures before making any trading or investment decision. Figures marked n/a could not be reliably sourced. Wednesday's Asian index closing levels, the German Bund yield, and CDS index levels (iTraxx/CDX) could not be confirmed at collection time and should be checked via Bloomberg or Reuters Eikon before use.